Overview of Methods – Data Sharing Analysis

The data presented here are part of a larger study, conducted to iteratively evaluate new question wordings and introductions with the goal of improving the accuracy of abortion reporting in surveys; these results are not included here but will be shared on the Qualitative Data Repository in a separate submission.

As part of the informed consent process for the larger interview study, the research team explained that respondents could opt into data sharing through an optional consent checkbox. Regardless of their response to consenting to data sharing, respondents were asked at the end of the interview to reflect on data sharing and their motivations for consenting or declining to consent to data sharing.

We conducted 64 in-person interviews with cisgender women in Wisconsin in 2020 and in New Jersey in early 2020 (states were selected for their variations in abortion climate in order to make findings less geographically specific). Eligibility criteria included: assigned female at birth, currently identify as a woman, between the ages of 18-49, English-speaking, and reported ever having penile-vaginal sex. Respondents were screened for abortion history as well to ensure that at least half the sample reported a prior abortion (for the purposes of the wider study).

Interviews were conducted in English by two members of the study team (see interviewer identities below), lasted between 60 and 90 minutes, and took place in-person in private locations. Interviews were audio recorded. Participants for the overall study was provided verbally and indicated whether they consented to data sharing by checking a box on the consent form and filling in their participant study ID number. Study remuneration was $150 cash. The study was reviewed and approved by the Guttmacher Institute's Institutional Review Board.

Audio recordings were transcribed by a professional transcription service and de-identified by research staff at the Guttmacher Institute. We developed a coding scheme for the sections of the interview related to the data sharing component focused on participants' understanding of data sharing and motivations for consenting or declining to consent to data sharing. Using NVivo 12, we coded the transcripts using this coding scheme. Upon completion of coding, we generated node reports and developed a matrix to identify themes.

Interviewer identities

Alicia VandeVusse conducted 32 of the 64 total cognitive interviews. She has a PhD in sociology from the University of Chicago. At the time the interviews were conducted (January to February 2020), she was a Senior Research Scientist at the Guttmacher Institute. Alicia identifies as a white, queer, cisgender

woman. She has extensive experience conducting in-depth interviews and focus groups, having conducted over 100 interviews and 50 focus groups during the course of her training and career. Alicia had no contact to the interview participants prior to the one-time interview. The participants learned that the study was about sexual and reproductive health, including abortion, during the recruitment and screening process, and during the informed consent process they were told that the focus was on improving survey questions about abortion. Given that these were cognitive interviews centered on abortion reporting, Alicia remained neutral regarding her own positionality and biases. In a few cases, if participants expressed hesitance discussing the highly stigmatized topic of their own abortion history, she disclosed that she supports abortion rights.

Jennifer Mueller conducted 32 of the 64 total cognitive interviews for project 483 (abortion underreporting). She has a Master of Public Health (MPH) degree in epidemiology and maternal and child health from the University of Washington School of Public Health. At the time the interviews were conducted (January to February 2020), she was employed as a Research Associate at the Guttmacher Institute. Jennifer identifies as a straight, white, cisgender woman. She has experience conducting in-depth interviews and key informant interviews, having conducted nearly 100 interviews over the course of her training and career. Jennifer had no prior contact to the interview participants prior to the one-time interview. The participants learned that the study was about sexual and reproductive health, including abortion during the recruitment and screening process, and during the informed consent process, they were told that the focus was on improving survey questions about abortion. Given that these were cognitive interviews centered on abortion reporting, Jennifer remained neutral regarding her own positionality and biases. In a few cases, if participants expressed hesitance discussing the highly stigmatized topic of their own abortion history, she disclosed that she supports abortion rights.